

MEDIA & PUBLIC RELATIONS

5 Steps to becoming a trusted public voice

From My PR Partner.

We live in an age of 24/7 news, where content is produced endlessly by news organisations across the nation and the globe, and social media spreads it quickly and widely. To meet that demand, journalists and media outlets need content continually.

The good news is that you can be a source of that content, and unlike advertising, media exposure is free. You may not have the expertise of a PR firm, but if you understand a few principles and follow these five steps, you can make a great start.

1 Understand the difference between PR / media coverage and marketing

Do not expect free marketing or advertising. What you have to say, or what you are doing, must be newsworthy, because it is the news. Have a realistic expectation of the story and how you will be portrayed, and present your pitch to the journalist as a matter of public interest. If you want to promote a new product or service, or publicise an expansion, make sure it has news value. Your new product might meet a community need, be a technological breakthrough, or help the environment. All of these carry public interest value when presented the right way.

2 Consider your authority to speak about a subject

Most news stories carry comments from a variety of people, because the journalist wants to present several angles and give the reader, listener or viewer a complete picture. Journalists are often not experts on the subjects they cover, so they look for people who are. Be willing to share your knowledge and advice in your area of expertise. When you are included in a story, it does not just build your credibility with clients and prospects, it also gives you great content for your marketing and social media.

3 Ask what value you can add to a current story

When a story breaks, there are almost always many follow-ups, each with a different theme and featuring different people. Media outlets want to keep covering an issue while public interest is high, but they need fresh angles. When you see something that relates to your expertise or your business, ask whether there is anything of interest you can add. Do not undervalue yourself or your input. Your knowledge or opinion could be exactly what is needed.

4 Monitor the media for stories that relate to your expertise

Anyone can keep an eye on what is appearing across digital media, and most stories are online, by creating a Google Alert with the key words you want. It is free, and to find out how, well, just Google it. This way you can see what is being said about your industry, react quickly, and apply the steps above.

5 Contact the journalist or media outlet

By now you know you possess specific knowledge and expertise, or you have a new product that could be of public interest. Perhaps you have seen an article and believe you can bring a different angle for a strong follow-up. But how do you let the outlet or journalist know, and what do you say?

You may not know how to write a media release, but you can send a brief email (a thesis will not be read) or message them on social media. Introduce yourself and make a pitch: tell them what you have to say and how it adds to their story or is of news interest. Most stories name the journalist, and some include contact details. If not, look them up on social media, or call the outlet and ask how to reach them.

Do not be shy, and do not worry if they are not interested. Not every pitch will land, but if you keep trying, you will get a breakthrough. Good luck.

TAKE THE NEXT STEP WITH MY PR PARTNER

Become a trusted public voice in your industry.

POWERED BY CRC PUBLIC RELATIONS

TALK TO US

1300 182 186